

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

'A chilling effect on business'

Loop businesses uneasy about possible National Guard deployment

By Brian J. Rogal
Chicago Tribune

With all eyes on the U.S. Supreme Court as it weighs whether or not the Trump administration can deploy the National Guard to Illinois, Loop business owners worry a bigger federal presence could scare off their customers and workers.

"I'm not seeing troops marching down Wacker Drive yet, but I do feel there is an increasing sense of anxiety," said Donna Lee, founder of Brown Bag Seafood Co., which operates seven Chicago restaurants.

Other downtown restaurants

have already seen lower foot traffic and staff not showing up to work, said Brad Alaoui, chief operating officer of Roanoke Hospitality, which runs five restaurants in River North and the Loop, including The Roanoke at 135 W. Madison St.

"We've had a lot of staff call off," he said. Restaurants are already more vulnerable because beef and produce prices are rising, "and as restaurant operators our costs will go up further without enough workers. That adds more pressure and uncertainty."

Chicago business leaders said a protracted occupation will further damage the city's econ-

omy, and pointed to conditions in Washington, D.C., and Los Angeles, where troop deployments and crackdowns on immigrants lacking permanent legal status launched by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security have tamped down everything from tourism and restaurant traffic to retail sales.

"It just creates fear, chaos and then that's going to hurt local businesses," said Jack Lavin, president and CEO of the Chicagoland Chamber of Commerce.

So far, downtown restaurants and other retailers haven't felt much pain from Operation

Turn to Downtown, Page 4



Brown Bag Seafood owner Donna Lee, right, calls out orders as they come in on May 8, 2024, at the restaurant on East Randolph Street in Chicago.

TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE



An angry crowd faces off with U.S. Border Patrol agents after a raid at Discount Mall on West 26th Street in Chicago's Little Village neighborhood on Thursday. ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Bovino accused of throwing tear gas at protesters in Little Village

Attorneys say Border Patrol field chief violated a temporary restraining order

By Gregory Royal Pratt,
Sam Charles,
Laura Rodríguez Presa,
Jason Meisner
and Tess Kenny
Chicago Tribune

Attorneys in an ongoing federal lawsuit Thursday accused Border Patrol Cmdr. Gregory Bovino who, according to recent testimony is the head official leading "Operation Midway Blitz," of violating a temporary restraining order by personally throwing tear gas toward a crowd of protesters during an immigration enforcement operation in the Little Village neighborhood.

Dressed in green fatigues with

his trademark high-and-tight haircut, Bovino was captured on video appearing to lob a canister while standing in a parking lot next to federal agents. A still image from the recording was included in a two-page court document filed in federal court by journalism advocacy organizations.

The filing alleged Bovino violated "multiple paragraphs" of a restraining order entered by U.S. District Judge Sara Ellis restricting when and how tear gas can be deployed by immigration officials when dealing with media and protesters.

The attorneys who brought the underlying suit told Ellis in

the filing they were "currently working on providing the court with declarations and additional evidence regarding this incident"

They also accused federal agents of using pepper spray and throwing at least one protester to the ground at a similar incident in Little Village on Wednesday.

According to that filing, a masked agent wearing no identification ordered the crowd on Wednesday to "clear the area" at one point, despite the fact that no one was obstructing any agents or their vehicles. Bovino and several other agents then confronted a woman who was recording the scene.

"What'd you say?" Bovino said,

according to the court document. "Did you make a threat?"

The woman denied making a threat, but Bovino ordered agents to take her phone, the filing states. The agents grabbed at the woman's shoulders and chest before pulling her to the ground, the document states. Once down, they knelt on the woman's back to restrain her, according to a photograph included in the filing.

The attorneys asked Ellis to conduct an inquiry into Bovino's actions and order any "relief" that she deemed proper.

Ellis conducted a lengthy

Turn to Bovino, Page 4

New panel to scrutinize immigration raid actions

Pritzker's 'accountability commission' to receive videos, testimonials

By Olivia Olander
Chicago Tribune

For weeks, Chicagoans and suburbanites have recorded masked federal agents pursuing people down streets, detaining them, and loading them into unmarked cars — scenes that have at times descended into chaos amid President Donald Trump's crackdown on illegal immigration.

Now, in a move that could bolster both his public messaging and the state's legal efforts to fight the Trump administration, Gov. JB Pritzker is seeking to channel those videos, testimonials and any allegations of misconduct into a centralized record overseen by a new "accountability commission." The panel, he said, will track and scrutinize the administration's actions with an eye toward future efforts to hold federal officials and employees accountable.

Announced Thursday in an executive order establishing the commission, the move follows weeks of resistance from Democratic-led states that have sought to challenge the Trump administration's law enforcement crackdowns largely through the courts. Pritzker has repeatedly acknowledged that Illinois, like other states, has few direct tools to counter federal actions beyond litigation and public accountability efforts.

Hamstrung by the state's limited authority to restrict federal immigration agencies, including U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement and Border Patrol, Pritzker said the commission will serve as a means of collecting and preserving evidence — material that could be used by a future Congress, presidential administration or in potential legal proceedings. While the panel will be empowered to recommend steps to hold the federal government accountable, Pritzker

Turn to Commission, Page 5

INSIDE

4 members of Bailey's family killed in crash

The son of Republican candidate for governor Darren Bailey, along with two of Bailey's grandchildren and daughter-in-law, were killed in a helicopter crash in Montana. **Page 2**

Step up to the plate, it's now Sho time

How does Shohei Ohtani's feat stack up against the greatest postseason performances of all time? **Chicago Sports**



Portland Trail Blazers head coach Chauncey Billups, center, walks to a vehicle after his federal court appearance on Thursday in Portland, Oregon. JENNY KANE/AP

NBA head coach, 30 others charged in gambling schemes

Indictment alleges rigged sports bets and poker games

By Alanna Durkin Richer,
Tim Reynolds
and Philip Marcelo
Associated Press

NEW YORK — The head coach of the Trail Blazers and a player for the Heat were arrested Thursday along with more than 30 other people in two criminal cases alleging sprawling sepa-

rate schemes to rake in millions by rigging sports bets and poker games involving Mafia families, authorities said.

Trail Blazers coach Chauncey Billups was charged with participating in a conspiracy to fix high-stakes card games in Las Vegas, Miami, Manhattan and the Hamptons that were backed by La Cosa Nostra Crime families. Heat guard Terry Rozier was accused in a second scheme to concoct fraudulent bets by

Turn to Charges, Page 9

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 54 Low 38

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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